



Introduction:

Controlling is one of the most basic functions of management, like planning, organizing, staffing, etc. Controlling is an important function, and without controlling management can't ensure the desired results.

Definition of controlling:

Controlling is the process of monitoring activities to ensure that they are being accomplished as planned and correcting any significant variations.

Importance of controlling:

- 1. Controlling motivates employees**
- 2. Controlling makes the efficient use of resources**
- 3. Controlling ensures coordination of action.**
- 4. Controlling helps in deciding the right judgment about the standards**
- 5. Controlling aids in the accomplishment of organizational goals**
- 6. Controlling helps in improving the performance of the employees**
- 7. Controlling helps in minimizing the errors**

Process of controlling:

1-Establishing standards:

This means setting up of the target which needs to be achieved to meet organizational goals eventually. Standards indicate the criteria of performance. Standards can be set in both quantitative as well as qualitative terms. It is important that standards should be flexible enough to be modified whenever required. Standards should be **SMART** as:

S-Simply Expressed

M-Measurable

A- Attainable

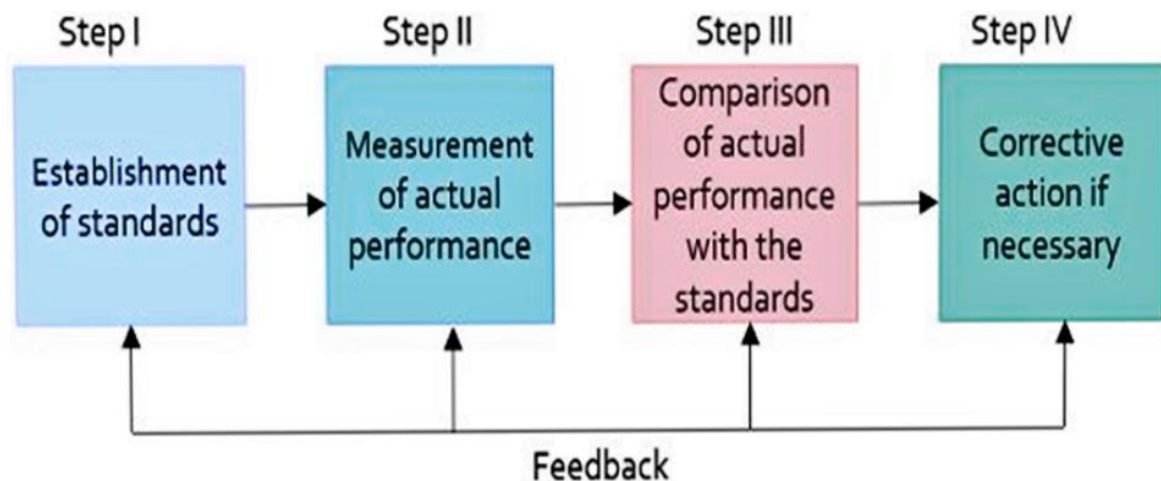
R- Reasonable

T-Time bounded

2-Measuring actual performance:

- Managers must measure actual performance to determine any variations from standard.
- Three common sources of information frequently used by managers to measure

actual performance:



1. Personal observation
2. Oral reports
3. Written reports

- The actual performance of the employee is measured against the target. With the increasing levels of management, the measurement of performance becomes difficult.

3-Comparing measured performance to established standards:

A third step asks the manager to compare the measurement against the standard.

A- This is an application asking a comparison between the what is and the what should be.

B- If the comparison results or measurements are acceptable, no action needs to be taken. If results show a trend away from the acceptable or show the unacceptable, action may be called for. The difference between what is and what should be is known as the deviation.

4-Taking corrective actions:

- It is initiated by the manager who corrects any defects in actual performance. Controlling process regulates organization's activities, so that actual performance conforms to the standard plan. An effective control system enables managers to avoid circumstances which cause the organization's loss.

- The last step, taking corrective action, depends on three things: the standard,

the accuracy of the measurements that determined a deviation exists, and the diagnosis of the person or device investigating the cause for the deviation.

- Corrective actions can be prescribed by management in advance through policies, procedures, and practices Some corrective actions may be automatic Some corrective actions may have to take exception to established policy, procedure, or practices.

Examples of such corrective action might include:

- Changing strategy.
- Changing structure.
- Training programs
- Redesigning jobs.
- Firing employees.

Types of controlling:

1-Feedback Control:

This process involves collecting information about a finished task, assessing that information and improvising the same type of tasks in the future.

- These post-performance controls focus upon the end results of the process. The information obtained is used for corrective purposes. Adjustments and/or corrections follow the feedback input.

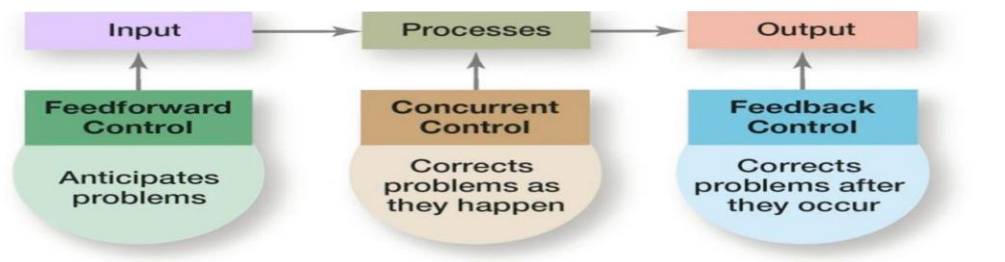
2-Concurrent control:

It is also called real-time control, in-process" or "steering controls. It checks any problem and examines it to take action before any loss is incurred.

3-Predictive/feed forward control:

- This type of control helps to foresee problem ahead of occurrence. Therefore, action can be taken before such a circumstance arises.
- In an ever-changing and complex environment, controlling forms an integral part of the organization.
- It is future directed: they are designed to detect and anticipate deviations from standards at various points. Such preventative controls focus on establishing conditions that will make it difficult or impossible for deviations from norms to

occur. Examples include job descriptions, job specifications, inductions, and orientation.



Control Systems:

The composite Feedback, Concurrent, and feed forward control make up a "package" or "system." A system is a combination of any two or more controls.

Characteristics of effective control system:

1. **Suitable:** The control system must be suitable to the needs of an organization.
2. **Simple:** The control system should be easy to understand and operate.
3. **Economic feasibility:** compares the costs to the benefits.
4. **Accuracy:** The information for the control must be useful and accurate.
5. **Forward Looking:** control system should be forward looking. It must provide timely information on deviations.

Methods of controlling:

1-Direct Supervision and Observation:

It is the oldest method of controlling. The supervisor himself observes the employees and their work. This brings him in direct contact with the workers.

2-Financial Statements:

All organizations prepare profit and loss account. It gives a summary of the income and expenses for a specified period. They also prepare balance sheet, which shows the financial position of the organization at the end of the specified period. Financial statements are used to control the organization.

3- Management by Objectives (MBO):

MBO facilitates planning and control. It must fulfill following requirements objectives for individuals are jointly fixed by the superior and the subordinate.

Periodic evaluation and regular feedback to evaluate individual performance.
Achievement of objectives brings rewards to individuals

4-Self-Control:

Self-Control means self-directed control. A person is given freedom to set his own targets, evaluate his own performance and take corrective measures as and when required. Self-control is especially required for top level managers because they do not like external control.

Role of nurse manager for controlling:

- 1-Gave an employee a job performance evaluation.
2. Encourages followers to be actively involved in the control process.
3. Clearly communication expected standards of care to subordinator.
4. Uses control as a method of determining why goals were not met.
5. Support/actively participates in research efforts to identify and measure.
6. Accesses appropriate sources of information in data gathering for control.
7. Is politically active in communicating control.